Anaikantika-hetu (inconclusive reason): one of the major types of logical fallacy (***hetvabhasa***). There are three varieties:

1. When the logical reason (***hetu***) occurs in cases where what is to be proved (***sadhya***) is absent (that is, it occurs in ***vipakshas***).
   Example: the village is holy, because it is close to the Ganges. But there are unholy things close to the Ganges. This is called *Sadharana-hetu*.
2. Where the logical reason only applies to the subject (***paksha***) of the inference (*Asadharana-hetu*). Example: sounds (***paksha***) are impermanent (***sadhya***), because they are audible (***hetu***). It is a condition of an inference's validity that we should be able to cite an instance (***sapaksha***) other than the subject of the inference where both the logical reason and the property to be proved always occur together. But this is impossible here because nothing other than sounds have the property of audibility.
3. Where the subject of the inference is universal. For example 'Everything is nameable, because it is knowable'. The invariable association is, 'Whatever is knowable is nameable'. Distinct from the universal subject, there can be neither a ***sapaksha*** nor a ***vipaksha***, showing the invariable association (***vyapti***) between the logical reason and what is to be proved. Since the inference begins from a question about whether nameability applies to the subject, the invariant association 'whatever is knowable is nameable' is itself doubtful.

Further reading: G. Bhattacharya 1989; Potter and Bhattacharya 1993

Anatta (no soul): Buddhists deny that the subject of thoughts, feelings, actions and their consequences is a permanent,